coach kris

The Voice You Feed

A 7-Day Experiment to Stop Negotiating With Yourself.

Seven days. One playbook. No perfection required.

> "Is there new evidence?"

COACH KRIS

WELCOME

You Probably Already Know What To Do

Eat better. Move more. Sleep properly. Put the phone down. Do the work. Have the conversation. Start the thing.

The problem is rarely a lack of information. It is what happens between knowing and doing.

You make a decision while clear. Later, another voice begins negotiating.

This week is not about becoming perfect. It is about learning to hear that negotiation before it quietly becomes your decision.

You will observe your real life, catch recurring arguments, make a few decisions before temptation arrives, check whether circumstances genuinely changed, and test what happens when you act deliberately.

The aim is not maximum control. It is conscious participation in your own life.

YOUR SEVEN-DAY RESULT

- ✓ I can recognise my most common negotiation.
- ✓ I know the situations that trigger it.
- ✓ I can tell the difference between new evidence and a new argument.
- ✓ I have a simple way to pre-decide my response.
- ✓ I have a personal playbook I can use after this week.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

You do not need to print this workbook or type into a PDF. Keep a notebook beside you. Whenever you see IN YOUR NOTEBOOK, write the heading and answer there. The workbook guides the process; your notebook holds the work.

BEFORE DAY 1

The 7-Day Agreement

Give me seven consecutive days. Do not wait for a perfect week. Your real life is part of the experiment.

1. **Do not restart.** A difficult day is data, not a reason to go back to Day 1.
2. **Do not overdo it.** This is not a punishment challenge or an invitation to extreme fasting, exercise, restriction, or sleep deprivation.
3. **Write the negotiations down.** Catch the exact words whenever you can.
4. **Be honest.** Nobody is grading this workbook.
5. **Adjust when there is genuine new evidence:** illness, injury, family needs, safety, medical advice, or circumstances that truly changed.
6. **Do not confuse discomfort with danger.** Growth can contain friction; harm is not the goal.
7. **Read the next day's page** before your next waking period when possible, so you can decide before the negotiation arrives.

YOUR SCHEDULE STILL COUNTS

This workbook runs on “Day 1” through “Day 7”, but your life does not run 9 to 5. If you work nights, rotate shifts, care for children, travel, or wake at unusual times, translate “morning” as your first clear period after waking and “evening” as later in your waking period. The method follows your real life, not the clock.

IMPORTANT

If you have a medical condition, a history of disordered eating, take medication, are pregnant, or are considering a significant change to diet or exercise, use appropriate professional medical guidance. This workbook is never a reason to ignore pain, illness, genuine exhaustion, medication needs or medical advice.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

Why am I giving myself these seven days?

◆ THE ROADMAP

Seven Days. One Progression.

S	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
See my current reality	Hear it	Predict it	Decide before it arrives	Check the evidence	Choose consciously	Create evidence through action	Build my personal playbook

The process is simple. Notice ◆ Predict ◆ Decide ◆ Check ◆ Choose ◆ Test ◆ Build.

SETUP - THIS IS WHAT YOU ARE BUILDING

By Day 7 you will have one simple Negotiation Playbook. You do not need to complete it now. Each day will give you one piece.

MY #1 TRIGGER
When does the negotiation usually appear?

MY #1 NEGOTIATION
What does it actually say?

MY CLEAR-HEADED DECISION
What did I decide before the pressure arrived?

MY EVIDENCE CHECK
What would genuinely justify changing the decision?

MY WARNING SIGNS
How do I know I am drifting?

MY RETURN RULE
What puts me back in the decision quickly?

Seven days. One personal decision system.

◆ SETUP

Your Recent Reality Check

Look back 24-72 hours - only as far as you can remember accurately. You are not building a perfect baseline. You are looking for the moment where a clear intention became a negotiation.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - ONE RECENT EXAMPLE

One thing I intended to do differently was...

The moment it changed was...

What I told myself in that moment was...

What I did instead was...

KEEP IT LIGHT

If you remember three useful examples, write three. If one example already exposes the pattern, that is enough. Do not turn the setup into a research project.

SETUP - WHERE IS THE GAP?

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

Where is the biggest gap between the life you are practising and the life you say you want?

What do you already **know** you should probably be doing differently?

At the moment you do not do it, what usually happens?

What do you normally tell yourself?

Write one decision you expect yourself to negotiate tomorrow.

You are not looking for a personality flaw. You are looking for the moment the negotiation begins.

SETUP

Your Ideal Ordinary Day

Not Bali. Not retirement. Not winning the lottery. Imagine an ordinary day with your current responsibilities, but lived in a way that feels good to you.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

How would the first part of your waking day feel?

How would you eat, move, work, connect, rest and sleep?

When your head hits the pillow, what would make you think, “That was a good day”?

DO NOT OVERBUILD THIS

You are not designing your entire future. You are giving yourself enough contrast to notice where your current decisions keep drifting away from the day you actually want.

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

Not every thought deserves to become a decision.

DAY 1 / 7

Hear It: The Voice You Feed

TODAY'S WIN

"I noticed before I obeyed."

01 - THE IDEA

A PERSONAL EXAMPLE FROM KRIS

I have caught myself making a clear decision to put the phone down, finish what I was doing, or go to bed - and then hearing a surprisingly reasonable case for "one more check." Email. Facebook. Instagram. Back to email. Nothing dramatic happened. That was the point. The argument did not sound like an enemy. It sounded like me, calmly explaining why this tiny exception made sense.

That made one idea difficult to ignore: Not every thought deserves to become a decision.

Your negotiator may sound like: "Tomorrow." "Five more minutes." "I've earned this." "One won't matter." "I'm too tired." "I've already ruined today."

02 - TODAY'S EXPERIMENT: THE 10-SECOND PAUSE

For the next 24 hours, do not overhaul your life. Catch the negotiation. Ask: What had I originally decided? What am I telling myself now? What actually changed?

Is there new evidence, or just a new argument?

NEGOTIATION LOG - CATCH ONE CLEARLY

One honest, specific example is more useful than three rushed ones. Catch the exact words if you can.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - NEGOTIATION LOG

What I intended... What the voice said... What I chose... How I felt afterwards...

If more appear: jot them down in a few words. Optional quick notes - capture only what seems useful.

◆ DAY 1 - MEET YOUR NEGOTIATOR

Which Strategy Appears Most Often?

The Postponer
"Tomorrow."

The Rewarder
"You deserve it."

The Minimiser
"One won't matter."

The Protector
"Don't risk it."

The Perfectionist
"You already messed up, so what's the point?"

YOUR NEGOTIATOR MAY PUSH, NOT PROTECT

Not everybody's voice tells them to do less. For some people it says: "One more hour." "Rest is weakness." "You haven't done enough." "Don't delegate." "Push through." Same Negotiator. Different costume.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

My most common negotiator is...

Its favourite sentence is...

When I did **not** follow the negotiation today, who made that decision?

Tomorrow we stop waiting for the voice to arrive before deciding.

Predict It

TODAY'S WIN
"I knew the negotiation was coming."

Yesterday, the negotiation may have surprised you. Today, we study its timing.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - PREDICT TODAY'S NEGOTIATION

What negotiation do I predict will appear today?

What usually triggers it - time, hunger, stress, boredom, tiredness, phone, sofa, work, another person, or something else?

Approximately when or where does it appear?

What do I normally do after hearing it?

THE PATTERN SENTENCE - MAKE THE SCRIPT PREDICTABLE

When _____ happens, I tend to tell myself _____, and then I usually _____.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

Write your pattern sentence.

When it appears today, label it: "There it is." Then notice the exact argument.

What did the voice say today? What surprised me about how predictable it was?

What does this teach me about when I am most vulnerable to renegotiating?

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

Decide before you negotiate.

DAY 3 / 7

Decide Before You Negotiate

TODAY'S WIN

"I protected one decision I made while clear."

Why ask your tired, tempted, distracted self to remake a decision your clear-headed self already made?

Don't repeatedly reopen decisions you've already made, unless evidence appears.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - MAKE THE DECISION WHILE CLEAR

The decision I am making while clear is...

I expect my negotiator to say...

I made this decision because...

I will reconsider it if this genuinely changes...

DAY 3 - PROTECT THE DECISION

Use Language That Fits the Decision

"Not never. Not tonight." is one example - not the rule. It works well for some discretionary comforts because it postpones the negotiation without turning the choice into a lifetime ban.

- "Not skipping. Not today."
- "Decision already made."
- "I can reconsider tomorrow while clear."
- "No new evidence. Continue."

USE APPROPRIATELY

This is for discretionary habits, cravings, avoidance and renegotiation - not for skipping necessary meals, medication, sleep, medical care, pain signals or other genuine needs.

MAKE THE ENVIRONMENT HELP

- Move the phone away if it repeatedly steals bedtime or attention.
- Prepare the meal or item you already decided you would use during a busy shift.
- Put the shoes where starting movement is easier.
- Remove work apps from your personal phone if "one more check" is your pattern.
- Make genuine recovery easier too if overwork is your default.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

One environmental change that will support today's decision.

When the predicted negotiation arrived, what happened?

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

State before story.

DAY 4 / 7

Check the Evidence

TODAY'S WIN

"I stopped treating every feeling or thought as the whole dataset."

Sometimes "I'm too tired" is a negotiation. Sometimes you are genuinely exhausted. Sometimes "I need rest" means an early night. Sometimes the Negotiator uses "discipline" to convince you to push when your body is clearly asking for recovery.

Your job is not to blindly ignore yourself. Your job is to improve the quality of the decision.

1. **What state am I actually in?**
   Sleep. Food. Pain or illness. Stress. Movement. Recovery. Useful data if I already have it.

2. **Does this create meaningful new evidence?**
   Has something genuinely changed enough that the clear-headed decision should change - or has my mind found a new argument for the same old pattern?

IMPORTANT

Genuine pain, illness, acute exhaustion, injury, medication needs, medical advice, safety concerns or meaningful new circumstances are evidence. This workbook is never a reason to override them.

◆ DAY 4 - OPTIONAL DEEPER CHECK

Use More Detail Only When It Helps

If the two-question check gives you enough clarity, act on it. If you genuinely need more information, look deeper.

SLEEP
How did I actually sleep?

NOURISHMENT
Have I eaten appropriately for my needs?

MOVEMENT
What has my body done today?

STRESS
What is actually happening in my life?

STIMULATION
How much screen, noise or input have I had?

RECOVERY
Have I genuinely recovered?

AVAILABLE DATA
Does useful objective information support or challenge my story?

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - FINISH THE EVIDENCE CHECK

The story my mind offered was...

The strongest evidence I have is...

Decision: keep / adjust / stop / recover - and why?

Is there new evidence - or just a new argument?

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

Did I choose it, or did it choose me?

DAY 5 / 7

Did I Choose It, or Did It Choose Me?

TODAY'S WIN

"I put myself back into one automatic decision."

The enemy is not pizza, Netflix, gaming, comfort, pleasure, rest or ambition. The question is whether you are participating in the choice.

> **Comfort should be somewhere you visit, not somewhere you're trapped.**

THE 90-SECOND CHOICE

Catch one automatic reach today: food, phone, television, gaming, procrastination, shopping, work, or something else.

Name it: What am I about to do?

Ask why: What am I hoping this gives me?

Ask: Did I choose this, or did it choose me?

Check: Hunger? Tiredness? Stress? Avoidance? Relief? Stimulation? Connection? Genuine pleasure?

Choose again. You may still do it - but choose it.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

The automatic behaviour I caught. What triggered it?

◆ DAY 5 - WHAT AM I ACTUALLY REACHING FOR?

Curiosity, Not Psychoanalysis

Sometimes hunger is hunger. Eat appropriately. Sometimes rest is exactly what you need. Sometimes you simply want the thing and consciously choose it.

Other times, the reach for food, scrolling, work, shopping or another comfort is carrying a different request: relief, reward, stimulation, connection, escape, reassurance or habit.

The point is not to psychoanalyse yourself. It is to know whether you chose it.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

What did I expect this behaviour to give me?

What did it actually give me afterwards?

If there was another need underneath it, what was it?

What is one conscious response that could meet that need?

What did I deliberately choose to enjoy today?

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

The edge of your comfort isn't necessarily the edge of your capability.

DAY 6 / 7

Test One Decision

TODAY'S WIN

"I created evidence instead of another promise."

Today is not about extreme discomfort. It is about choosing one meaningful thing you have repeatedly negotiated away and testing yourself at an appropriate level.

HARDER DOES NOT AUTOMATICALLY MEAN FORWARD

If pushing is already your default, your test may be resting, delegating, stopping, asking for help, saying no, eating adequately, or leaving something unfinished. Never use this exercise to push through injury, illness, meaningful pain, acute exhaustion, medical warning signs or professional medical advice.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - BEFORE THE TEST

One thing I have repeatedly said I would do but keep negotiating away.

Why does it feel uncomfortable? What do I predict will happen if I do it?

What would a safe, appropriate 4-7/10 version of this challenge look like **for me**?

When and where will I do it?

◆ DAY 6 - AFTER THE TEST

Notice What Actually Happened

4-7/10 DOES NOT MEAN PAIN

It can mean awkward, uncertain, exposed, effortful or unfamiliar. A work test might be publishing a short piece instead of endlessly editing. A relationship test might be starting a conversation. An overachiever's test might be deliberately stopping.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

What actually happened?

How uncomfortable was it before / during / after?

What was easier than expected? What was harder?

What do I now know about myself that I did not know this morning?

Capability needs evidence.

THE VOICE YOU FEED SAYS

Progress is not only the streak. It is also how quickly you notice and return.

DAY 7 / 7

Build Your Negotiation Playbook

TODAY'S WIN

"I leave with a repeatable way to catch, check and answer my most common negotiation."

Seven days have not made you perfect. Your negotiator has not disappeared. The point is that it should be harder for it to operate completely unnoticed.

> **IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - START THE PLAYBOOK**
>
> The situations in which I negotiate with myself most often are...
>
> My #1 trigger is...
>
> The three sentences my negotiator uses most often...

DAY 7 - FINISH THE PLAYBOOK

Your Decision, Evidence and Return Rules

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

When I hear my #1 negotiation, the clear-headed decision I want to remember is...

MY EVIDENCE CHECK

- What did I originally decide? What actually changed?
- What does my physical state tell me?
- What does useful real-world data tell me?
- Is this genuine new evidence, or a new argument?

Progress is not only the streak. It is also how quickly you notice and return.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK - RETURN RULES

I know I am drifting when...

My first small return action will be...

◆ YOUR KEEPSAKE PLAYBOOK

My Negotiation Playbook

Keep this. Screenshot this. Return to it. If you are working digitally, build the final version in your notebook and keep these six headings somewhere easy to revisit.

MY #1 TRIGGER

When does the negotiation usually appear?

MY #1 NEGOTIATION

What does it actually say?

MY CLEAR-HEADED DECISION

What did I decide before the pressure arrived?

WHAT COUNTS AS GENUINE NEW EVIDENCE

What would truly justify changing the decision?

MY WARNING SIGNS

How do I know I am drifting?

MY RETURN RULE

What puts me back in the decision quickly?

MY NEXT MOVE

The smallest action that puts me back in the decision.

FINAL REFLECTION

What Did You Learn About Yourself?

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

The negotiation I can hear now that I barely noticed seven days ago.

The situation in which I am most vulnerable to it.

One decision I am proud I protected. One thing I proved I can do.

One automatic behaviour I want to keep questioning.

WHAT DO I WANT TO PROTECT NEXT?

Do not solve your entire life on this page. Choose something close enough to act on.

IN YOUR NOTEBOOK

One part of my life that matters enough to protect is...

One decision I keep negotiating away in that area is...

The rule I want to carry into next week is...

The next piece of evidence I want to create is...

The voice you feed is not the loudest voice. It is the one you keep returning your decisions to.

Keep your Negotiation Playbook. Keep collecting evidence. When you drift, notice sooner. When circumstances genuinely change, adjust intelligently. When only the argument changes, remember what you decided while clear.

◆ WHAT COMES NEXT

Awareness Creates a New Question

This week was designed to solve one small problem: helping you recognise the negotiations that repeatedly pull you away from decisions you genuinely wanted to make.

Once you can hear them, a deeper question naturally appears:

What conditions, routines, environment, health foundations, recovery and personal challenges help you operate in a way that makes those negotiations easier to navigate?

That is a bigger piece of work. It is where Alignment begins.

For now: keep the playbook. Keep listening. Keep choosing.

coach kris.

coachkris.co.uk